

AFIFAH KASHIF

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EDUCATION

University of Cambridge

June 2026

MPhil in Human-Inspired Artificial Intelligence

Dissertation: Bias by Whose Definition? The Construct Validity of Dictionary-Based and LLM-as-Judge Bias Evaluation in Conversational AI (Supervisors: Dr. Malak Sadek, Dr. Jin Huang, Dr. Hatice Gunes)

Highlighted Courses: Responsible AI, Neuroscience & AI, Algorithms for Human-AI Collaboration, Ethics of AI

University of Washington (UW) – Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering

June 2025

B.S. Computer Science; GPA: 3.77/4.0, Dean's List

Minor: Law, Societies & Justice, Graduated 1 year early

Highlighted Courses: AI/Computer Ethics, Distributed Systems, Law in Society, Machine Learning, AI, Algorithms

Capstone Project: [Ointment Care Robot for Limited Mobility Users](#)

Study Abroad: Rome Italy, Jan - Mar 2024, Honors: The Global Refugee Crisis: From Devastation to Diaspora

Bellevue College

June 2022

A.A. Arts and Science, A.S. Engineering, Physics and Atmospheric Sciences; GPA: 3.98/4.0, Dean's List

Completed 2 associates degrees in tandem to high school for dual credit, allowing early undergraduate graduation

SELECT HONORS AND AWARDS

Cambridge Excellence Award - Top 5 Nominee

2026

Winner - LLM and Law Research Pitch [Cambridge Business School x Stanford LiftLab]

2026

Marcy Migdal Fellowship + Fund for Educational Equity, UW Center for Global Study, \$1500

2025

Distinguished Leader Award, Harvard WECODE

2023

Received multiple merit-based scholarships totaling \$17500

RESEARCH

Beyond the Monolithic Interface: A Research Agenda for Plural Conversational AI

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (Nature Portfolio) [Submitted]

Avijit Ghosh, **Afifah Kashif**, Isabelle Kohout, Zhenzhen Qi

Vision-Language-Action Models Need Neuroscience's Evaluation Toolkit, Not Just Its Architectures

NeurIPS 2026 Position Paper Track [Submitted]

Abdul Muhsin Hameed, **Afifah Kashif**, Asim Iqbal

Governance as Methodology: Toward Anticipatory, Design-Embedded Governance for Human Robot Interaction

2nd Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics Workshop @ ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2026

Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek

Governance at the Edge of Architecture: Regulating NeuroAI and Neuromorphic Systems

arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.01503

Afifah Kashif, Abdul Hameed, Asim Iqbal

Regulatory Considerations for Physically Assistive Robotics Researchers

Physical Caregiving Robots Workshop @ ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2025

Afifah Kashif, Amal Nanavati, Maya Cakmak

Assessing GPT's Bias Towards Stigmatized Social Groups: An Intersectional Case Study on Nationality Prejudice and Psychophobia

Considering Cultural and Linguistic Diversity in AI Applications Workshop @ Association for Information Science & Technology (ASIS&T) 2024

Afifah Kashif*, Heer Patel*

*equal contribution

Broadening Participation in Computing by Designing Hackathons that Engage Local Communities

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Odyssean Institute**, *Civic, Open & Resilient Democracy Action Democracy Fellowship* Apr 2026 – Present
- Coding expert responses, extracting causal variables, and building causal loop diagrams for AI governance horizon scan
 - Applying Python-based analysis and LLM APIs to process input at scale for decision support tools in 2026 UK assembly
- PluralisticAI Lab**, *Research Assistant (Dr. Zhenzhen Qi [UConn], Dr. Avijit Ghosh [Hugging Face])* Mar 2026 – Present
- Co-designing a controlled human subjects study evaluating whether an open-source, multi-persona LLM platform reduces political polarization and improves conceptual understanding among users
 - Developing IRB protocol, measurement instruments, and qualitative analysis framework for a 30+ participant study
- Teaching (Various)**, *Supervisor, Course Founder, Teaching Assistant Roles* Sep 2023 – Mar 2026
- Led and held various supervisory and teaching initiatives across the **University of Cambridge**, **University of Washington**, **Stanford Code in Place** and in **Rome**, ranging in subjects from computer science, digital literacy, and language proficiency
 - Launched digital literacy program for refugee women w/ **International Rescue Committee**, Kabul Community Services Seattle
- HelloRobot**, *Robotics Software Engineering Intern (UX + Human Robot Interaction)* May 2025 – Aug 2025
- Designed an interactive dashboard and workflow for an assistive in-home robot, iteratively prototyped and user-tested for trust, reliability, and operator agency
 - Evaluated assistive robot behaviors through real-world user studies and healthcare data analysis, identifying failure modes in autonomous decision-making
- Wordplay Project @ UW Information School**, *Research Assistant (Dr. Amy Ko)* Sep 2024 – June 2025
- Led design and deployment of accessible, multilingual programming language learning platform in local schools
 - Conducted literature reviews and usage analysis to create educational governance and ethical development structure
- HowellCo¹, Code.org², Fiveable³** *Internships [Software Engineering^{1,2}, Operations/Product³]* April 2021 – Sep 2024
- ¹Built and tested backend infrastructure for a mobile app (Python, Azure, React)
 - ²Developed and designed full-stack web-based coding lab, improving educational access for marginalized students
 - ³Scaled internal operations and product workflows through company's transition into a consumer platform

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

- Cambridge AI Research Society**, *AI Research Events Lead* Jan 2026 – Present
- Coordinated with Google Deepmind, Microsoft Research, Mistral AI and other industry partners to coordinate speaker events
- Cambridge Institute of Technology and Humanity**, *Academic Representative* Oct 2025 – Present
- Ensured a fulfilling interdisciplinary experience for students in the University of Cambridge's Centre for the Study of Existential Risk, Leverhulme Centre for the Future of Intelligence and Centre for Human-inspired AI
- Researcher**, *EvalEval Coalition* Sep 2025 – Present
- Participating in global coalition of interdisciplinary researchers in coalition on AI evaluations, see published [blog post](#)
- Nordic Scholars Leadership Institute**, *Scholar* June 2025 – Sep 2025
- Selected for inaugural cohort of immersive program on Nordic best practices in sustainability, governance, and innovation through trust-based and collaborative leadership in Stockholm, connecting with academics, industry leaders and government
- UW Pakistani Student Association**, *President* Sep 2023 – June 2025
- UW Women in Law Society**, *Vice President and Co-Founder* May 2023 – May 2025
- Paul G. Allen School Student Advisory Council**, *Executive Officer* Nov 2022 – Sep 2024
- TechTogether Seattle MLH Hackathon**, *Programming and Outreach* June 2022 – May 2023
- Hosted Seattle's first women-only hackathon, nation's largest hackathon initiative addressing gender inequities in tech
- Council of American-Islamic Relations**, *Youth Advisory Board* Nov 2021 – April 2023
- Worked with WA State Governor Jay Inslee and non-profit to ensure equitable experiences for Muslims and Afghan refugees

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Programming Languages: Java, JavaScript, Python, HTML/CSS, Node.js, C/C++, Ruby, TypeScript, React, SQL
Frameworks & Tools: Rails, Bootstrap, Git, ROS, Bash, Linux/UNIX, LaTeX, Azure, AWS, TensorFlow, PyTorch
Research Methods: Qualitative Coding, Survey Design and Analysis, Literature Review, User Studies